

is ensuring last-mile connectivity, making clean energy accessible to every household and industry.

In line with the Hon'ble Prime Minister's vision, India is transitioning towards a gas-based economy. Natural gas, a cleaner alternative to conventional fuels, is poised to play a pivotal role in this shift. The government has set ambitious targets to increase the share of natural gas in the primary energy mix from 6% to 15% by 2030. This transition is being facilitated by initiatives such as the City Gas Distribution (CGD) network, expansion of LNG terminals, and promotion of Compressed Natural Gas (CNG) and Piped Natural Gas (PNG) for consumers and industries alike. To accelerate this shift, Budget 2025 has earmarked USD 5 billion for the expansion of the CGD network, ensuring wider coverage in urban and semi-urban areas. India's commitment to sustainability is evident in its massive push for biofuels and green hydrogen. With an investment of USD 4 billion in Ethanol Blended Petrol (EBP) plants, the country is on track to achieve 20% ethanol blending by 2025, significantly reducing carbon emissions and reliance on fossil fuels. Additionally, the National Green Hydrogen Mission, backed by a USD 2.3 billion investment, is positioning India as a global hub for hydrogen production, driving innovation in clean energy technologies. Budget 2025 has provided further impetus by introducing a Production-Linked Incentive (PLI) scheme for green hydrogen manufacturing, attracting global and domestic investments in the sector.

Moreover, recognizing the importance of international collaboration, India has been actively forging partnerships to attract investments in the oil and gas sector. The country has witnessed USD 30 billion in investments in refining and petrochemicals and an additional USD 25 billion in renewables, showcasing its commitment to a diversified energy mix. MoPNG is also working closely with global energy leaders to drive innovations in carbon capture, utilization, and storage (CCUS), further strengthening India's climate action roadmap. The 2025 Budget has also introduced a USD 1.5 billion fund to support CCUS projects, reinforcing India's leadership in carbon neutrality initiatives. Digital innovation is revolutionizing India's energy sector, enhancing efficiency, transparency, and accessibility. The government's initiatives, such as the Unified Energy Interface (UEI) and digital monitoring of fuel distribution, have optimized resource allocation, reduced pilferage, and improved consumer services. Moreover, MoPNG's emphasis on digitalized recruitment and operational processes has streamlined workforce management, ensuring efficiency across the sector. In Budget 2025, a special allocation of USD 500 million has been made for AI-driven energy management systems, further modernizing India's energy sector.

As India continues its journey towards energy self-reliance, MoPNG's visionary policies and initiatives, supported by strategic allocations in Union Budget 2025, are playing a crucial role in shaping the nation's energy future. The strides made today will not only ensure economic growth but also establish India as a global leader in the energy sector, empowering every citizen with accessible, affordable, and clean energy.

India's Renewable Energy Surge: A Global Leader in Sustainability

India has emerged as a global leader in renewable energy, demonstrating an unwavering commitment to sustainability and climate action. With bold policy interventions and strategic investments, the country has significantly increased its installed renewable energy capacity, solidifying its position among the top nations harnessing green energy sources. Today, India boasts an installed renewable energy capacity of over 190 GW, with wind and solar energy as key drivers. The Union Budget 2025-26 has reaffirmed the government's commitment to accelerating the green transition by allocating ₹50,000 crore for the expansion of renewable energy infrastructure, with a strong focus on solar, wind, and hybrid energy projects. A significant portion of this investment—₹15,000 crore—has been earmarked for solar manufacturing under the Production-Linked Incentive (PLI) scheme, aiming to strengthen domestic supply chains and reduce dependence on imports.

One of the standout achievements has been the rapid expansion of solar energy. Large-scale solar parks, rooftop solar initiatives, and a push for domestic manufacturing have significantly contributed to capacity addition. The PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana, with an outlay of ₹75,000 crore, aims to provide rooftop solar installations to 1 crore households, reducing electricity costs and promoting decentralized solar adoption. Alongside this, onshore and offshore wind projects have played a crucial role in substantial power generation, further reinforcing India's renewable energy push. India's commitment to sustainability extends beyond generation capacity. The Union Budget 2025 has announced a ₹20,000 crore allocation for battery energy storage systems, ensuring seamless grid integration of renewable energy. Additionally, the government has introduced Viability Gap Funding (VGF) for pumped hydro storage projects, enhancing the reliability and efficiency of India's power sector.

In a major push toward clean energy leadership, the National Green Hydrogen Mission, backed by an investment of ₹2.3 billion (₹19,000 crore), is positioning India as a global hub for hydrogen production, driving innovation in green hydrogen technologies. The Union Budget 2025 has further strengthened this commitment by announcing tax incentives and subsidies to boost the adoption of green hydrogen in industries such as steel, fertilizers, and transportation. Aligning with its global commitments under the Paris Agreement, India remains steadfast in achieving its non-fossil fuel energy capacity targets and is well on track to becoming a net-zero economy by 2070. With renewable energy momentum continuing to accelerate, strategic budgetary allocations, and visionary policy frameworks, Bharat is set to reinforce its role as a global renewable energy powerhouse, driving economic growth, energy security, and environmental sustainability.

With a relentless focus on innovation, self-reliance, and sustainable growth, Bharat is charting a bold course toward global leadership. As the nation accelerates its economic, infrastructural, and energy transformation, Prime Minister Modi's vision of Viksit Bharat stands as a testament to a resilient, future-ready, and self-sufficient India–powering progress, securing prosperity, and shaping a brighter tomorrow for all.

